

190 countries in contract enforcement. Deven R. Choksey, MD of KR Choksey Holdings, blames it on the old framework: “Bureaucrats end up amassing more powers through archaic laws and bring discredit to ease of doing business. While the government is trying to clean up the legal framework, the process is not moving at the desired rate.”

Moreover, in the event of a dispute between the central and state governments, infrastructure projects suffer long delays. “While the central government does the heavy lifting, state governments are often found lacking in their implementation,” says Choksey, adding that’s why results vary from one state to another. Take the case of the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High Speed Rail corridor that slowed down after the swearing-in of the former Uddhav Thackeray-led Maha Vikas Aghadi government. It may have jacked up the cost of the ₹1.8-lakh crore project by a few thousand crores.

So, how will this relationship mature? “That is difficult to predict as these things evolve with the needs of the time,” says Sanyal. “A key issue will be the process of transferring resources to the third tier of government—municipalities and panchayats.” He sees this shift to grassroots as empowering development over the next 24 years.

THE COUNTRY’S FAMED resilience and the ability to leapfrog technologies are expected to support growth. For example, IMF has termed Direct Benefit Transfer—that transfers welfare money directly to bank accounts of beneficiaries—a “logistical marvel” given the country’s sheer size. “The systematic roll-out of digital infrastructure has not only resulted in increasing tax compli-

